

MY EX'S MAFIA UNCLE WANTS ME AS HIS BRIDE

Full Scripts

Total Episodes 50

Free episodes 1-9

EPISODE 1

1. INT. HOSPITAL ER ROOM – NIGHT

On screen text – 5 YEARS AGO

Hazy first-person POV. Fluorescents blur. Muffled shouting.

Henchman (O.S.)

Stay with us, Boss –

A young woman's (YOUNG HANNAH/20yr) face leans in. early-twenties.
Tired eyes. Masked. Calm hands.

YOUNG HANNAH (V.O.)

Sir, Can you hear me? You're gonna be okay.

(To nurse) Pressure here. Now!

POV eyes flutter shut. Black.

2. EXT. MED SCHOOL PARKING LOT – PRESENT – AFTERNOON

HANNAH CARTER (25), graduation gown over scrubs, walks toward her beat-up Toyota Corolla. Diploma case in hand. Behind her – running footsteps.

ROMAN NORTON (43) breaks from between two cars. Soaked dark at the abdomen. Blood between his fingers. He sees Hannah. Stops dead. Recognition.

ROMAN

(half to himself) ...you.

Three men round the corner. Guns visible. Roman yanks Hannah's back door open, shoves her in, climbs after, slams it.

HANNAH

What the – GET OFF –

He pulls her onto his lap. Hand at her neck.

ROMAN

(fast, low) If you want us alive just follow my lead.

He kisses her. Hard. His other hand presses a pistol grip against her lower back. A gunman taps the car window.

GUNMAN

Roll it down.

ROMAN

(into her ear) Do it.

Hannah's hand shakes. Window cracks two inches.

HANNAH

(furious) Can't you see I'm busy? Take the hint and FUCK OFF.

The gunmen pause. Glance at each other. Walk away. Hannah turns, hand raised to slap him — stops. Roman has gone slack. Eyes half-shut. Blood pooling on her gown.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

(panic) Oh my God. We're going to the hospital.
Now!

Roman's hand catches her wrist, weak.

ROMAN

No hospital. Anywhere but a hospital.

She tries to pull free. He's slipping. She struggles to break free. But he suddenly goes limp in her arms.

ROMAN (CONT'D)

(almost inaudible) ...finally.

EPISODE 2

1-1. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT — NIGHT

Cramped apartment. Desk lamp pulled close. Roman lies on the bed, shirt cut away.

A bullet wound just above his groin. Hannah kneels between his legs. Suture kit open. Bloody towel beside her.

HANNAH

Luckily, the bullet didn't go through. You're really lucky. You almost died.

She threads the needle. Roman stirs. His fevered gaze locks onto her and doesn't let go.

ROMAN

Doctor.

HANNAH

Don't talk.

ROMAN

You're shaking.

HANNAH

I'm closing a gunshot in my apartment. Yes, I'm shaking.

Hannah threads the needle through his skin. Roman reaches up and slowly tucks a strand of hair behind her ear.

ROMAN

You're very good.

HANNAH

Stop talking. I need to focus.

He lets out a low laugh, then winces. Hannah seals the dressing, breathing unevenly now.

Her hand lingers on his thigh a second too long. Roman slowly covers it with his own.

His thumb brushes against her skin. Silence. Heavy. Intimate.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

(whisper) Who are you?

His eyes close slowly. The last of the tension melts from his body before he collapses against her. Hannah gently lowers him back onto the bed.

1-2. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT— PRE-DAWN

Hannah sleeps against the side of the bed. Roman's eyes open, clear now. He sits up carefully, testing the wound. He pulls on his torn shirt and crosses to her. Gently, he brushes the hair from her cheek.

ROMAN

(whisper) Get some sleep. I'll come back for you.

Kisses her forehead. Walks out.

2. EXT. STREET BELOW — PRE-DAWN

Five black sedans sit in formation. The second Roman appears, his right-hand man MARCO(29yr) hurries toward him.

MARCO

Boss, you okay?

ROMAN

(quiet) She saved my life. Find out everything.
Her name. Her family. By tomorrow.

He gets in. The sedan pulls away.

3. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT — MORNING

Hannah jolts awake in the chair. Looks at the bed. Empty. Sheets pulled flat. Beside the bed, a trash can. She straightens slowly.

HANNAH

(soft) ...Was it a dream?

She touches her cheek. Too vivid to be one.

EPISODE 3

1. INT. JULIAN'S APARTMENT HALLWAY — DAY

Hannah, scrubs on, walks down the hall with a paper bag — coffee and pastry. Her step is light. She stops at his door. Hand raised to knock. From inside a muffled gasp. A woman's laugh. She presses her ear against the front door. Another moan. She tries the knob. Unlocked.

2. INT. JULIAN'S APARTMENT — CONTINUOUS

Bedroom door open. Hannah walks in like a sleepwalker. JULIAN (26), handsome, smug. MIRA VANCE (26), polished, in nothing but a diamond on her left hand. They see Hannah. Both freeze. Mira doesn't cover herself. Smiles slowly.

MIRA

Oh. Hannah.

Julian sits up. Irritated more than ashamed.

JULIAN

You should have knocked.

Hannah's grip on the bag tightens. Coffee leaks through.

HANNAH

(almost cry) Five years, Julian.

JULIAN

(sighing) You think I'm gonna throw my future away for a broke doctor begging for hospital bills?

Mira lifts her left hand. Wiggles the diamond.

MIRA

We're engaged. Two weeks ago.

JULIAN

You should be happy for me.

A sharp laugh escapes Hannah. She stares at him in disbelief.

HANNAH

The wedding fund. Three years of savings. Give it back. Now!

Mira's smile widens. Hops out of bed, naked. Picks up Hannah's paper bag.

JULIAN

What money?

It's gone. I used it to buy the ring.

Mira picks up the fallen iced coffee and dumps it over Hannah's head. Then throws the empty cup against her chest.

MIRA

Take your trash out with you
She closes the door in Hannah's face.

3. INT. JULIAN'S HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Hannah stands. Muffled laughter restarts inside. Her phone buzzes. She looks down. The screen reads: HOSPITAL EMERGENCY LINE. Hannah picks up.

HOSPITAL STAFF (V.O.)

Ms. Carter, your mother's surgery has been
scheduled for three days from now.
But if the payment isn't made by the day after tomorrow, the surgery
will be canceled.
Hannah's legs give out beneath her. She sinks to the floor.

EPISODE 4

1. INT. JULIAN'S OFFICE — DAY

Open-plan startup. Twenty employees. Julian at the coffee bar, laughing. He sees Hannah enter. Face drops.

JULIAN

What the hell are you doing here?

Don't be pathetic. Just get out

She crosses the room. Every head turns.

HANNAH

The wedding fund. Three hundred thousand. Wire it back. Now!

JULIAN

(hissing) Lower your voice.

HANNAH

(louder) Stealing my savings wasn't enough?

You even took out a loan against my apartment.

I don't wanna hear excuses. I need that money now.

JULIAN

That money was an investment in OUR future —

HANNAH

THERE IS NO OUR.

SLAP. Loud. A girl at a desk gasps.

JULIAN

(vicious, quiet) Security.

Two guards approach. Behind them — Mira walks in with shopping bags. She takes in the scene. Smiles.

MIRA

(loud, theatrical) My fiancé's crazy ex. Of course. Get her out.

The guards grab Hannah's arms.

HANNAH

Give me my money back!

You stole my future! And now my mother's dying because of it!

They drag her past Mira. Mira leans close.

MIRA

Stop being so pathetic over a little money.

You're the doctor. Figure out how to save your mom.

Hannah's eyes lock on hers. Burning. She's dragged away.

2. EXT. STREET — DAY

Hannah stands frozen at the curb, clutching her phone.

A message flashes across the screen: SURGERY PAYMENT DUE TOMORROW
Sunlight washes over her face. Her eyes filled with tears.

3. INT. DIVE BAR — AFTERNOON

Half-empty. Hannah at the bar counter seat, scrubs on. Three empty glasses.

BARTENDER

Last one, Doc.

She drinks. Down the bar, a THUG (30yr) watches. He slides over two stools.

THUG

Bad day?

HANNAH

Worst.

THUG

Let me get you outta here. Show you a good time.

His hand lands on her wrist.

HANNAH

(swatting weakly) Get your hand off —

Hannah pushes herself to her feet, trying to get away from him.

She stumbles straight into a stranger's arms.

EPISODE 5

1. INT. DIVE BAR — CONTINUOUS

Hannah tries to pull away from the stranger's arms.
But her body won't cooperate.

THUG

Hey, man. She's already spoken for.
C'mon, baby. Get over here.
Roman doesn't look at him. The thug reaches for Hannah's shoulder.
Roman takes the thug's wrist. CRACK. The thug screams. Hits the floor. Roman steps over him.

ROMAN

Alright, Doctor. Time to go.
Hannah, drunk, blinks up. Her hand drifts up to his cheek.

HANNAH

(slurring) Wait... I know that face.
A soft laugh slips from Roman, like he finds her adorable.

ROMAN

Come on. Doctor.
He scoops her into his arms and carries her out.

2. INT. CAR — NIGHT

The city lights blur outside as Roman drives. Hannah's head rests in his lap. He never pushes her away. Their eyes meet. Roman gently brushes his thumb across Hannah's lips.

3. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT — NIGHT

He carries her up. Sets her on the edge of the bed. Steps back to leave. She catches his shirt.

HANNAH

(eyes shut) Don't leave me tonight. Stay.
Roman goes still.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

Please.
Her eyes open. Wet. Wide. Roman leans down. Cups her face.

ROMAN

(soft) If you regret this in the morning, blame me. Don't blame yourself.
She pulls him down. They kiss. He follows her onto the bed. A beat. She breaks the kiss, looks up at him. Roman slowly pulls off his shirt, revealing a hard, sculpted body.
Hannah stares, visibly impressed.

HANNAH

I don't even know your name.

ROMAN

(soft, against her mouth) ...you don't have to.

His mouth crashes against hers in a deep kiss. Roman's hand slides slowly down her body.

Fingers gripping skin.

Hannah gasping softly beneath him.

Roman breathing hard, sweat running down his neck.

Their bodies move together in heated flashes of intimacy.

EPISODE 6

1. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT – MORNING

Hannah wakes. Roman sleeps on his stomach, one arm across her waist. She freezes. She lifts the sheet. Looks down. At him. Blushes hot.

HANNAH

(whisper) Oh my god. Oh my GOD.

Inches out from under his arm. Tiptoes. Yanks on scrubs.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

(under breath) Best sex of your life with a stranger. What is WRONG with you.

Phone buzzes. MOM. She steps into the bathroom.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

(whisper) Mom? Surgery confirmed?

MOM (V.O.)

Hannah, baby. They said the payment didn't go through. The bank says... the account is empty.

Hannah's face goes white. Pulls up her banking app. Balance: \$0.00

Recent transactions: Three transfers. Recipient: J. NORTON

HANNAH

(quiet) Julian. You son of –

Mom, please don't worry...I'll do whatever it takes

BANGING on the front door. Loud.

VOICE (O.S.)

Open up!

Hannah opens the bathroom door. Roman is sitting up in bed. Alert. Already reading her face.

ROMAN

Who is it?

2. INT. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT DOOR – CONTINUOUS

A bank representative arrives with two sheriff's deputies.

BANK OFFICER

Hannah Carter. This studio was put up as collateral on a personal loan. The loan is in default. Vacate by tomorrow at noon.

HANNAH

I never –

BANK OFFICER

The co-signer was Julian Norton. Your signature was on file as well. Notarized.

HANNAH

No... that's impossible...

He forged it.

BANK OFFICER

That's a matter for the police.

He hands her the paperwork. They leave. Hannah slides down the closed door. Paperwork in her lap.

Roman, who has been listening from the bed, stands. Pulls on his pants. Walks over. Lowers himself to the floor in front of her.

ROMAN

I'll handle it.

HANNAH

(looking down) Last night was a mistake.

I don't even know who you are.

(looks up at Roman) Wait...

You're the man who got shot.

ROMAN

Finally.

The doctor recognizes me.

HANNAH

(bitter laugh) I'm serious.

My mom needs that surgery money today.

If you lend me the money... I'll do anything

Her phone chimes. Hospital alert: SURGERY HOLD STATUS — 2 HOURS REMAINING.

ROMAN

Marry me.

A beat.

HANNAH

What!

EPISODE 7

1. INT. HANNAH'S STUDIO APARTMENT – CONTINUOUS

Hannah's lips part in shock. Then she quickly pulls herself together.

HANNAH

One year. I work every shift. I pay you back every dollar.

ROMAN

(slow smile) One year is enough? Fine.

He rises and offers her his hand. The second Hannah takes it, he pulls her into his arms.

ROMAN

(slow smile) Give it a year, little Doc.

You'll beg to stay.

His thumb slowly brushes across her lower lip before slipping gently into her mouth.

Hannah's breath catches.

2. INT. CITY HALL – REGISTRATION OFFICE – DAY

Beige walls. A bored clerk behind the counter. Hannah in a clean, simple dress. Roman in a fresh suit. They sign the papers. The clerk glances at Roman – instantly startled.

CLERK

(slightly nervous) Congratulations... Mr. and Mrs. Norton

Hannah holds the certificate

ROMAN

Your mother's surgery was paid for the moment you signed.

HANNAH

(quiet) Thank you...

I swear I'll pay you back within a year.

ROMAN

You keep your promise, I keep mine.

3. EXT. CITY HALL STEPS – DAY

They walk down. Three black SUVs pull up. Eight suited men step out, synchronized. Marco bows from the waist.

MARCO

Congratulations on the marriage, Boss.

A second man bows. A third. All of them.

MARCO (CONT'D)

The family is honored.

Hannah freezes on the third step. Hand tightens on Roman's sleeve.

HANNAH

(whisper) What are —

Roman glances back at an older man behind them

ROMAN

(whispers in Hannah's ear) Him. He's their boss.

He gestures. MARCO catches Roman's eye, inclines his head almost imperceptibly.

HANNAH

(eyes huge) Wait... people like that actually exist?

ROMAN

Apparently.

HANNAH

Let's GO —

She drags him past the crew. Roman lets her. As they pass, Roman gives a subtle gesture for him to leave. Marco immediately backs away. Hannah doesn't even notice.

4. EXT. NORTON ESTATE GATES — DAY

The car turns into a drive. Wrought iron gates the size of a building. Open silently. A mansion rises. Hannah stares.

HANNAH

Wait. YOU live here?

ROMAN

We live here.

Car stops. He gets out. Opens her door.

5. INT. MANSION ENTRY HALL — CONTINUOUS

Vast marble foyer. Staff of six lined up, heads bowed. Roman walks her past them without slowing. They reach the grand staircase. He turns to face her. Hand at her waist. Leans in. Her eyes widen — his mouth an inch from hers

ROMAN

Welcome to your new home, Mrs. Norton.

EPISODE 8

1. NT. MANSION ENTRY HALL — CONTINUOUS

Hannah's hand presses flat against Roman's chest. Stops him.

HANNAH

I'm your wife. On paper.

I'll make us dinner

She slides out from under his arm. Walk toward the kitchen, head high.

2. INT. MANSION KITCHEN — LATER

Warm kitchen light. Hannah stands at the stove, sleeves rolled up, stirring a pot of homemade tomato soup and grilled cheese on the counter beside her.

Roman, jacket off, leans against the marble island with a glass of red wine, watching her quietly. He pours her a glass and slides it across the counter.

ROMAN

You don't have to cook.

HANNAH

You helped my mother.

I wanted to do something for you.

She drinks half the wine. His phone buzzes. Face hardens slightly. Roman steps away to the window before answering his phone.

ROMAN

You looked into it?

MARCO (V.O.)

Yeah, Boss. Bank officer confirmed Julian forged her signature. We're removing Hannah from the loan tonight.

ROMAN

Make him beg publicly. I want the whole thing recorded.

He pockets the phone.

They eat at the island. Hannah on her third glass. The food is good. A long beat. She sets down her wine glass.

HANNAH

Why are you being kind to me?

Roman sets his glass down. Studies her. Stands. Walks around. Slowly kneels in front of her stool.

ROMAN

Because you saved my life and didn't ask my name.

Hannah's breath stops.

ROMAN (CONT'D)

And if Julian ever makes you cry again..., I will
kill him.

Her eyes well. Roman rises. Cups the back of her neck. Pulls her into
a kiss. Slow. Deliberate. She lets him. Her hand fists in his shirt.

Roman settles Hannah on the marble island, then disappears beneath
her line of sight.

Hannah's fingers tangle in his hair.

A breathless sound escapes her before she can stop it. Her hand flies
to her mouth in embarrassment.

Roman comes back up with a smug little smile. He slowly wipes his
lips clean, eyes still locked on hers. Then he kisses her deeply
again.

ROMAN

Easy, Doctor.

You've got work in the morning.

Sleep early. Good girl.

Hannah bites her lip, clearly disappointed.

HANNAH (V.O)

Every time he touched me...

I knew I shouldn't want it.

But every touch only made me want him more.

EPISODE 9

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — ER — DAY

Hannah's first shift. Scrubs, hair tied back. She finishes a suture on a teenager.

HANNAH

You'll have a story for school. Keep it dry.

The teen grins. Hannah peels off gloves, walks to the nurses' station. The ER doors BURST OPEN. MIRA, designer coat, six-inch heels. Voice at maximum.

MIRA

Who hired this pathetic excuse for an employee?

Where is the director?

I want this woman FIRED. NOW!

Behind her two large men. Suits. Earpieces. Private security. They plant themselves at the ER entrance. Block it. An orderly steps toward Mira. One suit puts a flat hand on his chest. Doesn't speak. Stops him.

The staff hesitate. Hannah, behind the station, goes still.

HANNAH

(low to a nurse) Call security. Call the director.

NURSE

(into the desk phone) Security to ER —

The line clicks dead. The nurse looks at the receiver, confused.

NURSE (CONT'D)

That's weird. Line just —

Mira crosses to Hannah.

MIRA

(theatrical) There she is. Who gave you permission to work here? Certainly not me.

HANNAH

I got hired through a real interview.

What gives you the right?

MIRA

(amused) Wow. You really have no idea who I am.

I'm the director's daughter. Didn't Julian mention that?"

(looks her up and down) Actually... never mind. You weren't worth explaining things to.

Hannah's blood ices. Mira planned the timing. Mira sweeps an arm to a rolling surgical tray. Picks up a SCALPEL.

MIRA (CONT'D)

Stay away from my man. I know you're still hung
up on Julian.

He chose me. Get over it and get lost.

Scalpel an inch from her cheek. Hannah doesn't flinch. Doesn't step
back.

HANNAH

He's not your man.

A beat.

HANNAH (CONT'D)

He's trash. And so are you.

Mira's face contorts. Arm whips back. The scalpel swings. The tip of
the knife barely grazes Hannah's cheek.

A single thread of blood traces down her jaw onto the white collar of
her scrubs.

One spot of red on white. Two. Three. The ER is silent. Staff frozen
at the door, held back by the suits. Mira looks at the scalpel. At
Hannah's bleeding face. Her eyes have gone past plan. Past reason.
She raises the blade again. Higher. Aimed at Hannah's eye.

MIRA

Do you want me to make sure you never work as a
doctor again?

Do you understand now?

Hannah's face goes pale with fear. Suddenly the ER doors slam open.
Men in dark suits stride inside.

ROMAN (O.S.)

Take your hand off her!

Roman stands at the ER entrance, flanked by his men in dark suits.
Calm. Untouchable. Deadly

----- PAYWALL -----

EPISODE 10

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL - ER - CONTINUOUS

Mira frozen, blade still raised. The ER doors held open by Roman's men.

ROMAN walks in. Suit. Calm. Untouchable. Marco a step behind. The two suited "private security" men at the entrance who had been blocking the staff - they turn, lower their heads, and step back.

Roman crosses the ER. Slow. Every head turns.

Mira, still gripping the scalpel, watches him approach.

MIRA

Who the hell do you think you are?

Roman doesn't answer her. His eyes are on Hannah. On the thin line of blood down her jaw. He stops in front of Mira. Holds out his hand, palm up.

ROMAN

(quiet) The knife. Now.

Mira hesitates. Roman doesn't move. Doesn't blink. She drops the scalpel into his palm. He sets it on the rolling tray. Then takes her wrist. CRACK. Mira screams. Hits the floor.

ROMAN

On your knees.

Already there. She tries to stand. He puts a hand on her shoulder. Keeps her down.

ROMAN

(to the room) This is my wife. Anyone who touches her again loses more than a wrist.

The word wife lands across the entire ER.

MIRA

(panicked, looking up) W-wife?

Roman ignores her. Crosses to Hannah. Cups her uninjured cheek. Thumb gently against the cut on her cheekbone. His voice drops - soft now.

ROMAN

I'm sorry. I should've gotten here sooner.

Hannah, still shaking. On the floor, Mira fumbles for her phone with her good hand.

MIRA

(into phone) Julian, answer your phone! Your ex just married some random gangster."

God, her life is pathetic

Roman, over Hannah's head, looks down at Mira. Slow smile. Roman picks up a knife from the tray and raises it toward Mira's face. The blade stops just short of her skin.

ROMAN

(coldly) An eye for an eye.

(steps closer) Let's see whose life turns pathetic in the end.

Roman throws Hannah over his shoulder and walks out without looking back. Blood trickles down Mira's cheek.

MIRA

(screaming hysterically) "AAAAH!!

EPISODE 11

1. INT. ROMAN'S CAR — DAY

Roman in the back seat. Hannah beside him. Bandage being applied to her cheekbone. The car moves smoothly through traffic — they're already off hospital property.

HANNAH

You carried me out.

ROMAN

I did.

HANNAH

The hospital staff were watching.

ROMAN

They were.

HANNAH

You cut her face. In front of forty witnesses.

Roman, calm.

ROMAN

She cut yours first.

Hannah, processing.

HANNAH

Roman. The police will be at the mansion by tonight.

ROMAN

(slow smile) The police aren't going to do anything, little Doc.

HANNAH

How do you know.

ROMAN

Stop asking questions you're not ready for the answers to.

Hannah's mouth opens to push back. Roman's hand finds hers in her lap. Doesn't grip. Just rests there. She doesn't pull it back.

ROMAN

Today you got hurt because I wasn't fast enough. That won't happen twice.

A long beat. The car turns onto the road toward the mansion.

HANNAH

(quiet) I have a shift Friday.

ROMAN

You have a shift whenever you want one. I'll have someone walking three steps behind you the whole time.

HANNAH

Three steps?

ROMAN

Two if you ask.

Hannah looks out the window. Tries not to smile.

HANNAH (V.O)

What have I gotten myself into?

HANNAH

I'm not going to ask.

ROMAN

(slow smile) Eventually you will.

HANNAH

Don't be so sure of yourself.

ROMAN

Doctor. I've been sure since the parking lot.

Roman lightly squeezes his hand in her lap. Hannah keeps her eyes on the window. But the moment his hand tightens around hers, her cheeks turn pink.

EPISODE 12

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — NIGHT

Hannah, in soft borrowed clothes, sits at the marble island. Glass of red wine. Bandage on her cheek. Roman opposite her. Sleeves rolled.

HANNAH

I have rules.

ROMAN

(Slow smile) Of course you do, Doctor.

HANNAH

Separate bedrooms. Starting tonight.

ROMAN

Mm.

HANNAH

And no scalpels to anyone's face. Ever again.

ROMAN

That one I can't promise.

A beat. Hannah, despite herself, almost smiles.

HANNAH

Anything else I should know about my new husband?

ROMAN

A lot of things. Depends what you wanna know.

Roman slices into the peach with the dagger in his hand and eats one of the pieces. Juice drips slowly down his fingers. Hannah's cheeks flush pink. She clears her throat awkwardly.

HANNAH

Like what?

Roman slowly licks the peach juice from the dagger.

ROMAN

(slow smile) You'll learn one a week. Pace yourself.

HANNAH

One year. I pay back every dollar of my mother's surgery. Then we're done.

ROMAN

You won't even make it a week, little Doc.

HANNAH

We'll see.

Roman walks around the island. Stops behind her stool. Bends down. Brushes his lips against the back of her neck. Lingers.

ROMAN

Sleep well, wife. You know where your room is.

He walks out. Hannah, alone, lets out a long breath. Touches the back of her neck.

2. INT. HANNAH'S BEDROOM — LATER

Hannah in a long borrowed sleep shirt. Standing at the window. Looking out. A black sedan idles at the far end of the driveway. Marco beside it. Watching the mansion. Watching her window. She lifts a hand. Gives a small, dry wave. Marco, after a beat, dips his head once. Acknowledgment. She steps back from the glass.

EPISODE 13

1. INT. STAFF BREAK ROOM – DAY

Hannah at her locker. Bandage gone. Faint pink line on her cheekbone. Pulls open the door. Inside her locker – a photograph. Worn at the corners. She and Julian. Two years ago. Beach. Laughing. Folded underneath – a note. One line. His handwriting. I miss us. She crumples the photo. Drops it on the floor.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION – KITCHEN – EVENING

Hannah in the doorway. Roman at the counter, pouring two glasses of wine.

ROMAN

You're home early.

HANNAH

Day shift.

She takes the wine. Drinks half.

HANNAH

Someone got into my locker today.

His face shifts.

ROMAN

What did they leave?

HANNAH

A photo. Two years old. With Julian. A note.

First Mira, now Julian?

You're really trying to destroy my life at work

A beat.

Roman walks around the counter. Tips her chin up with two fingers.

ROMAN

I'll pick you up tomorrow.

Night shift, right?

Ten o'clock. I'll be waiting in the lobby.

HANNAH

You don't have to do that.

Julian's not crazy enough to come to the hospital.

ROMAN

(slow smile) You're my wife now.

Figure out what that means.

He leans down. Hannah's eyes squeeze shut automatically, expecting a kiss.

Her breath catches anyway. Roman lets out a quiet, amused laugh.

Then kisses her cheekbone instead — right beneath the scar. Hannah instantly blushes.

3. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — WOMEN'S LOCKER ROOM — EVENING

Hannah at her locker. End of shift. Just changed from scrubs into normal clothes. The locker room door creaks open. She turns. JULIAN steps in.

HANNAH

(jerks back, startled) You can't be in here.

JULIAN

Five minutes.

HANNAH

Get OUT.

There's something unhinged in Julian's eyes. He steps closer. Hannah instinctively takes a step back. Then another.

EPISODE 14

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — WOMEN'S LOCKER ROOM — CONTINUOUS

JULIAN

Come on, Hannah.

Don't do this. Just five minutes.

HANNAH

You cheated on me. With money you stole from me.

Stay away from me

JULIAN

Mira meant nothing.

It was for investors, okay? Her family's money was good for the company.

(steps closer) You know you're the one I actually love.

Julian suddenly slams Hannah against the wall. He pins both her wrists above her head with brute force.

JULIAN

Come on, Hannah. Don't throw your life away on a random thug.

The door SLAMS open. Roman lunges forward and slams his fist into Julian's face, sending him crashing to the floor. They crash to the floor, throwing punches wildly. Hannah tries to pull them apart, but it's useless. Roman ends up on top of Julian, fist pulled back for one final brutal hit. Then —

JULIAN

(slowly opens his tightly shut eyes and stares in shock)
Uncle Roman? What are you doing here?

The words hit Hannah like a gunshot.

Her head turns slowly toward Roman, eyes wide with shock.

HANNAH

(whisper) ...uncle?

Roman, finally, looks at Hannah. Slow smile.

ROMAN

Long time, nephew.

A beat.

ROMAN

(to Hannah) Meet your new aunt.

Before the words even finish leaving his mouth, Roman slams his fist into him one last time.

HANNAH (V.O)

Wait...I married my ex-boyfriend's uncle?

Hannah looks completely shaken. Suddenly, Mira comes rushing in, dressed head-to-toe in designer clothes.

 **PAYWALL #2**

EPISODE 15

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — WOMEN'S LOCKER ROOM — CONTINUOUS

Mira stops in the doorway. Designer coat. Heels. Eyes sweep the room — Julian on the floor, bloody. Roman standing over him. Hannah against the wall. Mira's mouth opens to scream — then stops. Calculation flickers behind her eyes. Fast.

She closes her mouth. Steps in. Closes the door behind her. Quiet.

MIRA

(slowly) Uncle. So that's why you covered for him.

She walks to Julian. Crouches.

MIRA

(soft, almost tender) Honey. Are you okay.

Julian, bleeding, confused — she's never used that voice with him before.

JULIAN

Mira —

MIRA

(stroking his hair, eyes on Roman) Shh. We're going home now.

She helps Julian to his feet. He leans on her. His blood smearing her coat. Mira looks at Roman over Julian's shoulder. Smiles.

MIRA

Mr. Norton. Such a pleasure to finally meet the family.

She walks Julian out. Calm. Heels clicking. The door swings shut behind her. Hannah, still against the wall, stares at the closed door.

HANNAH

You're his uncle?

ROMAN

Seems that way.

HANNAH

You knew?

ROMAN

No.

Roman crosses to Hannah. Lifts her chin. Examines her wrist — bruised where Julian gripped it.

ROMAN

He touched you.

HANNAH

Roman— that's not the important part right now.

ROMAN

(cuts her off) No.

My wife is the important part.

(steps closer) This will never happen again.

Marco steps in from the corridor.

ROMAN

The nephew stays where I can see him.

The fiancée? (smirks) Let her think she has leverage.

MARCO

Yes, Boss.

Roman wraps a hand around Hannah's bruised wrist. Gently.

ROMAN

Let's go home

EPISODE 16

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — HANNAH'S BEDROOM — MORNING

Hannah in bed. Hasn't slept. Sheets twisted. Phone in hand. She's been Googling. Screen: Roman Norton businessman. No real results. Norton family New York. News articles she can't parse. Roman Norton CEO. — a single business publication photo from three years ago. He looks the same. She closes the browser.

Knock at the door.

ROMAN (O.S.)

Breakfast.

Hannah doesn't answer.

ROMAN (O.S.)

(slow smile in his voice) Or I'll bring it up.

She gets out of bed.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — A LITTLE LATER

Coffee on the marble island. Roman, sleeves rolled, reading something on his phone. He looks up when Hannah enters.

ROMAN

You didn't sleep.

HANNAH

Hard to sleep after realizing the man I trusted could put his hands on me like that.

Roman sets down his phone. Carefully.

ROMAN

He won't be near you again.

HANNAH

You said that yesterday.

ROMAN

I meant it yesterday. I mean it more now.

Hannah takes the coffee. Doesn't sit.

HANNAH

I have a shift at ten.

ROMAN

You have whatever you want.

HANNAH

I want my shift.

ROMAN

Then take it.

Hannah turns to leave. Stops at the doorway. Doesn't look at him.

HANNAH

Roman. The way Mira looked at you. What card does she think she has.

A beat.

ROMAN

Whatever it is, I'll know by tonight.

She nods. Leaves.

3. INT. MIRA'S PENTHOUSE — SAME

Mira at a vanity. Mirror. Concealer. Working on the red line across her cheekbone.

Julian on the bed behind her. Stitched lip. Black eye. Sulking.

JULIAN

Mira. We need to talk about —

MIRA

We're not talking. We're thinking.

She caps the concealer. Studies her reflection.

MIRA

(quiet, to herself) Aunt-in-law. Imagine that.

She picks up her phone. Scrolls through contacts. Stops on one. Norton family attorney. A name she shouldn't have.

Smiles slowly.

EPISODE 17

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — ER — DAY

Hannah peels off gloves after a quick suture. Walks to the staff bathroom.

2. INT. STAFF BATHROOM — CONTINUOUS

Hannah at the sink. Splashes water on her face. Her stomach turns. Sudden. She bends over the sink. Closes her eyes.

HANNAH

(under breath) There's no way I'm pregnant.

It's probably just stress.

She counts on her fingers. The door opens. A nurse pokes her head in.

NURSE

Dr. Carter. Trauma bay 4. Wrist injury.

HANNAH

On my way.

3. INT. TRAUMA BAY 4 — A MOMENT LATER

Hannah walks in. Stops. MIRA on the gurney. Designer coat over hospital gown. Wrist wrapped in a bloodied scarf.

HANNAH

You're not supposed to be in this building.

MIRA

Excuse me?

I'm here as a patient, fair and square.

She lifts the scarf. A clean shallow cut. Self-inflicted.

MIRA

Mind doing them yourself?

Hannah, jaw tight, picks up gloves. Sits. Mira watches her hands work.

MIRA

(quiet) I had coffee with your husband's lawyer yesterday. Garrison.

Hannah's hand doesn't pause.

MIRA

He told me what your husband did five years ago.

HANNAH

I don't even know what you're talking about.

What happened five years ago?

MIRA

Ask him whose blood he was wearing besides his own.

The door slams open. ROMAN. Marco behind.

ROMAN

(to Mira) Get off my table.

Roman crosses. Lifts Mira off the gurney by her upper arm. Walks her out. Hannah, alone.

HANNAH

What's going now?

Looks at her shaking hands. The stomach turn comes back. Hard.

4. INT. CORNER DRUGSTORE — NIGHT

Hannah, scrubs under her jacket, alone in a pharmacy aisle. She stands in front of a shelf. Boxes. Pink and white. PREGNANCY TEST. Her hand rises. Lowers. Rises. Stops mid-air.

Her phone buzzes. Roman: Marco's outside. Whenever you're ready.

Her hand closes around a box. Lifts it. Holds it. A clerk behind her.

CLERK

Need help finding anything?

Hannah, startled.

HANNAH

No. I'm fine.

She puts the box back. Walks out empty-handed.

EPISODE 18

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — DINING ROOM — NIGHT

A long table. Two candles. Two place settings. Roman pulled out a chair for her. She sits. Food — simple, warm. Mushroom risotto. Bread. Wine.

HANNAH

You cooked.

ROMAN

The chef cooked. I asked for what you ate the night we married.

Hannah, surprised — she did make a simple pasta that first night.

HANNAH

You remember.

ROMAN

I remember everything about you, Doctor.

She picks at the food. Doesn't touch the wine. He notices.

ROMAN

No wine tonight?

HANNAH

Long shift.

She watches her own glass. Doesn't lift it. Roman doesn't push.

HANNAH

Tell me one thing about you.

ROMAN

Pick what.

HANNAH

Something small.

ROMAN

I don't like the ocean. Too much space.

Hannah laughs once. Real laugh. First in days.

HANNAH

That's the answer?

ROMAN

That's the answer.

HANNAH

Tell me a bigger thing.

ROMAN

You'll learn one a week. We agreed.

HANNAH

Why did you say finally the night we met.

Roman, the slow smile.

ROMAN

That's not a small thing.

HANNAH

Mira said something today about five years ago.

Do you know what she was talking about?

Roman sets down his glass. Stands. Walks around the table. Stops behind her chair. His hand brushes the back of her neck. Light. Asking. Hannah doesn't move. He bends. Kisses the curve of her shoulder. Hannah's breath catches.

ROMAN

(soft) When the time comes, you'll know.

Come upstairs.

Hannah looks at the hand.

HANNAH (V.O.)

Everything was so complicated now.

But I couldn't stop thinking about that night.

I wanted him.

She takes it.

They walk out of the dining room together. Her hand in his. Up the staircase. Past her blue door. Roman sweeps Hannah into his arms. She lets out a surprised gasp as he kisses her.

Without breaking the kiss, he carries her up the stairs.

EPISODE 19

1-1.INT. ROMAN'S BEDROOM — NIGHT

Dark wood. One lamp. A bed she has never seen before. Hannah at the foot of it. Roman behind her. Close. His hand finds her waist. Slow. Turns her to face him.

ROMAN

(soft) You can stop me anytime. One word,
Doctor.

HANNAH

(quiet) I know.

He kisses her. Slow. Then less slow. Her hands find his shirt. Fist in it.

He walks her backward to the bed. Sits her on the edge. Kneels in front of her.

Slides off her panty. Look up at her.

ROMAN

Tell me to stop.

HANNAH

Don't.

He rises. Leans over her. She lies back against the pillows. His mouth on her neck. Her collarbone. Then, Roman's hips begin to move, and Hannah can no longer stifle her moans. Roman's muscular body, Hannah's hands gripping him—skin against skin.

1-2.INT. ROMAN'S BEDROOM — PRE-DAWN

Hannah wakes. Roman sleeps beside her. She carefully slips out of bed. Reaching for the bedside lamp, she accidentally knocks a folder off the nightstand. The folder hits the floor. Papers spill out. Hannah freezes.

A document. Header visible. CITY GENERAL — STAFF HIRING APPROVAL — DR. HANNAH CARTER. APPROVED BY: R. NORTON, OWNER.

Underneath — another document. Older. A photograph paper-clipped to it. Surveillance image. Hannah. Five years younger. Med school ID. Walking out of a downtown ER at 3 AM. Date stamped. Hannah, very still beneath Roman.

HANNAH

(quiet) What is all this?.

He stops. Lifts his head. Reads her face.

ROMAN

(quietly) This isn't how I wanted you to find out.

HANNAH

(slow) You own my hospital.

ROMAN

(quiet) For two years now.

HANNAH

You knew I'd apply. You waited for me.

Roman, calm.

ROMAN

Doctor.

He stands.

ROMAN

I've been waiting five years.

Hannah's hand goes loose. The documents fall.

HANNAH

(whisper) What did you just say.

Roman steps toward her. Slow. The way he did in the ER the first time.

ROMAN

Sit down, Hannah.

What happened five years ago changes everything.

Hannah retreats. Her back hits the wall. Her hand instinctively rises — flattens against her stomach. Protective. Without thinking.

Roman stops. His eyes drop to her hand. To her stomach. Back to her face.

A long beat. He doesn't ask. Doesn't say it.

But the slow smile is gone.



PAYWALL #3

EPISODE 20

1-1.INT. BASEMENT PARKING GARAGE - NIGHT

A concrete floor. Single overhead bulb. MR. VANCE (60s, Mira's father, the former hospital director) on his knees. Suit rumpled. Sweating.

Roman in front of him. Suit. Calm. Marco behind. Two crew at the door.

ROMAN

Your daughter walked into my hospital today.
With a fake injury. To threaten my wife.

MR. VANCE

Mr. Norton - I didn't -

ROMAN

Your job, the day I fired you, was to keep her
on a leash.

Roman pulls a dagger from his jacket. Sets it flat on a table beside Mr. Vance. The blade points at the man's right hand spread on the table.

ROMAN

Pick.

MR. VANCE

W-what?

ROMAN

A finger.

Mr. Vance, weeping.

MR. VANCE

Please. She's my only daughter.

ROMAN

And she's my only wife.

Roman doesn't move. Doesn't blink. Mr. Vance, hand trembling.

MR. VANCE

Mercy. Mr. Norton. Mercy.

Roman lifts the dagger. THUNK. The blade plunges into the table, barely an inch from the man's hand. The man freezes.

ROMAN

You deliver a message to your daughter. Next
time, it's hers. Not yours.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION - SECOND FLOOR HALLWAY - SAME

Hannah, in a sleep shirt, walks the dark hallway. Couldn't sleep. Roman's bedroom door is open. Empty. She walks. The study door is open. Empty.

At the end of the corridor – a door she's never noticed.
Half-cracked. Light from below.

She steps closer. Looks down a flight of service stairs.

A voice carries up. Muffled. Roman's voice.

Hannah, slowly, descends.

1-2. INT. BASEMENT PARKING GARAGE - NIGHT

Roman turns. The smallest movement. Senses someone. His eyes lift to the doorway.

Hannah stands in it. Bare feet. Sleep shirt. Face white.

She has seen the dagger. The kneeling man. Roman's stillness.

ROMAN

(very quiet) Hannah.

She backs away. Turns. Runs up the stairs.

EPISODE 21

1. EXT. NORTON MANSION — GARDEN — DAWN

Hannah running across the wet grass. Bare feet. Sleep shirt. Just away. Footsteps behind her. Roman catches her arm at the rose garden wall. Pulls her around to face him.

She tries to wrench her arm free.

HANNAH

Don't touch me.

ROMAN

Hannah —

HANNAH

You had a man on his knees.

ROMAN

He let his daughter walk into my hospital with a knife.

(coldly) To threaten my wife.

HANNAH

You were going to cut his fingers off.

ROMAN

I wasn't.

HANNAH

The blade was at his hand.

ROMAN

It was a message. Not a wound.

HANNAH

Don't.

She rips her arm free.

HANNAH

This is what you are. The man cut people in the garage at 2 AM. That's the man I married.

ROMAN

Hannah.

HANNAH

I'm leaving.

ROMAN

Hannah.

HANNAH

I'm going to my mom's.

ROMAN

I'm not stopping you, Hannah.

(softly) But it's too late for you to go alone.

Marco will drive you.

She turns. Walks back across the wet grass. Doesn't look at him.

2. INT. MOM'S SMALL APARTMENT — LATER

A quiet, modest two-bedroom. MOM (Mrs. Carter, 50s), hair grey-streaked, sitting in an armchair with a blanket. Hannah curled on the couch next to her. Hair damp. Borrowed sweater.

MOM

You came here in a black sedan with a man in a suit driving.

HANNAH

That's Marco.

MOM

Who is he?

(concerned) You didn't get yourself into trouble trying to pay for my surgery, did you?

HANNAH

Mom, don't worry.

I'll take care of everything.

(holds her hand) You just focus on getting better.

3. INT. MIRA'S PENTHOUSE — SAME

Mira at her desk. Laptop open. Phone to her ear.

MIRA

(into phone) Mr. Garrison. I appreciate you taking the call.

GARRISON (V.O.)

Miss Vance. The Norton family attorney does not take calls from other families.

MIRA

Then think of this as a courtesy from a niece-in-law.

GARRISON (V.O.)

...go on.

MIRA

I have information about what Roman Norton did five years ago. Information he doesn't know I have.

GARRISON (V.O.)

Where did you get it.

MIRA

From the only person who was in the room with him that night. A doctor. My fiancé's ex.

EPISODE 22

1. INT. MIRA'S PENTHOUSE - KITCHEN - MORNING

Mira pouring two cups of coffee. Julian at the island. Mira slides him a cup. Smiles.

MIRA

We're going to be good now, you and me.

JULIAN

What do you mean?

MIRA

We're going to stop chasing your ex. We're going to stop calling Roman Uncle. Because — sweetheart.

She leans in. Touches his bruised cheek.

MIRA

Now I'm worth more than your last name.

Julian, confused.

JULIAN

What are you doing.

MIRA

I have a meeting today. With your uncle's lawyer.

JULIAN

Garrison talks to no one outside the family.

Mira raises her hand. The engagement ring sparkles under the light.

MIRA

I'm family.

Of course he took my call.

Julian goes still.

JULIAN

Mira — what did you tell him.

MIRA

That I know what happened five years ago. That Hannah told me everything last week, in confidence, in the locker room. Before she knew who you were to me.

A beat.

JULIAN

Hannah didn't tell you anything.

MIRA

(slow smile) Hannah doesn't have to know that, does she.

Julian, slowly, sets down his coffee.

JULIAN

You're going to use my uncle's wife as leverage.

MIRA

I'm going to use your uncle's wife to keep her husband from killing you. There's a difference.

A pause.

MIRA

You're welcome, honey.

She kisses his bruised cheek. Walks out. Julian, alone in the kitchen, picks up his phone. Scrolls. Stops on a contact.

EPISODE 23

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — EVENING

Hannah, back from her mother's. Suitcase by the door. Roman at the marble island. Cutting an apple with a dagger. Hannah's eyes drop to the dagger. Lingers.

Roman, noticing, sets the dagger down. Slow. Slides it across the marble away from himself. Picks the apple slice up with his fingers instead.

ROMAN

You came back.

HANNAH

I came back for clean clothes.

ROMAN

Mm.

He slides a piece of apple across the marble. She doesn't take it.

ROMAN

Tell me you're at least eating while you're hiding out at your mom's.

HANNAH

She made soup.

ROMAN

Good.

Hannah sits across from him. Doesn't take the apple.

HANNAH

Marco said you were looking for someone for five years.

ROMAN

He told you that.

HANNAH

When I asked.

ROMAN

What do you want to know, Doctor.

HANNAH

The man in the garage last night.

Roman doesn't blink.

ROMAN

Mira's father. Former director of my hospital.

HANNAH

Where is he now.

ROMAN

At home. With nine fingers and ten. He cried for an hour. Then he drove home.

HANNAH

You expect that to comfort me.

ROMAN

I expect you to know I didn't cut him.

HANNAH

Mira said you were wearing someone else's blood that night. Five years ago.

Roman's jaw locks.

ROMAN

She doesn't know what she's talking about.

HANNAH

Then tell me what she's talking about.

ROMAN

Not tonight.

HANNAH

Then when.

ROMAN

When you're ready.

HANNAH

I'm asking. That's being ready.

Roman looks at her.

ROMAN

Tomorrow. All of it.

Hannah stands. Walks toward the stairs.

ROMAN

Hannah.

She stops. Doesn't turn.

ROMAN

I won't apologize for finding you.

A beat.

ROMAN

But I'm sorry you saw what you saw.

Hannah, without turning, lets out a long breath.

HANNAH

Goodnight.

She walks up the stairs.

Through the kitchen window — Marco's sedan at the gate. And beside him — a second silhouette. Garrison. Roman sees them. Picks up his phone. Sends one text.

Tomorrow. My study. 8 AM.

EPISODE 24

1. INT. ROMAN'S STUDY — MORNING

8 AM. Hannah, in scrubs, hair tied back. She came back from her mother's for one reason — to hear what Roman promised last night. Roman behind the desk. Sleeves rolled. Coffee for two.

ROMAN

Sit.

She sits across from him.

ROMAN

Five years ago, three Ricci men shot me in a parking garage. My crew took me to the nearest ER. You stitched me. You didn't log my name. My crew paid the intake nurse to lose the chart.

HANNAH

I remember the patient. I never saw the face.

ROMAN

I saw yours. Pressure here, now. That's the only sentence I carried for five years.

HANNAH

You found me through the medical school registry.

ROMAN

Fourteen months ago. I bought your hospital. I waited for you to graduate.

HANNAH

And the parking lot.

ROMAN

Ricci hit me again that morning. I had nowhere to go. Then I saw you walk out of the building in a graduation gown. The universe paid me back, Doctor.

A long silence.

HANNAH

There's more.

ROMAN

There is.

HANNAH

What.

Roman, very still.

ROMAN

That's the part you're still not ready for.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

The five years. The hospital. That's what I owe you today. The rest – soon.

Hannah, after a long moment, stands.

HANNAH

I have a shift at ten.

She walks to the door. Stops.

HANNAH

Don't follow me to work today.

She leaves.

2. INT. CITY HOSPITAL – ER – LATER

Hannah at the central station. New face passing – DR. ETHAN REED (30s, tall, easy smile, sandy hair, white coat). He sets a coffee on the counter beside hers.

DR. REED

For you. You looked like you were running on fumes when you came in.

HANNAH

I don't take coffee from strangers.

DR. REED

Ethan Reed. New attending. Trauma. Not a stranger anymore.

A beat. Hannah, despite herself, almost smiles.

HANNAH

Hannah Carter.

DR. REED

I know who you are, Dr. Carter. Welcome to the worst-shift club.

He walks off. She looks at the coffee.

Across the ER – Roman's earpiece-suited man, three steps behind, watching.

EPISODE 25

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — STAFF CAFETERIA — DAY

Hannah at a table, picking at a salad. Dr. Reed slides in across from her with his tray.

DR. REED

You don't eat.

HANNAH

I eat.

DR. REED

I've watched you skip three meals in two days.
As your new attending, that's a problem.

HANNAH

You're not my attending.

DR. REED

I am as of Monday. I read your file.

Hannah, a real smile this time — small.

HANNAH

You read my file.

DR. REED

Top of your class at NYU Med. Three letters
from chiefs. And then you took the worst job in
the city.

HANNAH

The worst job has the best paycheck.

DR. REED

That tracks.

She actually eats a bite of salad. He notices. Doesn't comment.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION — STUDY — SAME

Roman at his desk. Marco across from him.

MARCO

Boss. The new attending. Dr. Ethan Reed. He
bought your wife a coffee this morning.

Roman doesn't look up.

ROMAN

Background.

MARCO

Clean. Brown alumnus. Wife died of cancer two
years ago. No kids. Came east from Seattle for
the fellowship line.

ROMAN

Watch him.

MARCO

Boss.

ROMAN

Don't touch him.

MARCO

Yes, Boss.

Marco leaves. Roman, alone, picks up his phone. Doesn't dial. Sets it down.

3. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — STAFF CAFETERIA — CONTINUOUS

Hannah, mid-bite, suddenly pales. Sets down her fork. Hand to her stomach.

DR. REED

Hannah.

HANNAH

I'm fine.

DR. REED

You're not.

She stands quickly. Walks toward the bathroom. Doesn't make it. Reed catches her elbow as she sways.

DR. REED

Come here. Sit.

He steers her to a chair against the wall.

HANNAH

Just tired.

DR. REED

That's not tired.

Their eyes meet. He doesn't say it. She doesn't either.

Dr. Reed pulls Hannah to somewhere

EPISODE 26

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — SUPPLY CLOSET — DAY

Dr. Reed pulls Hannah inside. Closes the door. Quiet. She's pale. Steady now, but pale.

DR. REED

Hannah. Are you pregnant.

HANNAH

No.

DR. REED

Have you tested.

HANNAH

No.

DR. REED

How late are you.

HANNAH

Six weeks.

Reed exhales.

DR. REED

You're a doctor. You know what six weeks plus nausea plus that almost-faint means.

HANNAH

I know.

DR. REED

Then why haven't you tested.

Hannah, very still.

HANNAH

Because if I haven't tested, it isn't real yet.

He looks at her for a long moment.

DR. REED

Hannah.

HANNAH

Don't tell anyone.

DR. REED

I won't. But you have to.

HANNAH

I will. When I'm ready.

DR. REED

You'll be ready when something forces you.
That's not a plan.

He pulls a small box from his coat pocket. A clinic-grade pregnancy test. Sets it in her hand.

DR. REED

When you're ready, the bathroom on the fourth floor is the quietest. I won't ask. But you should know.

Hannah looks at the box. Doesn't move.

HANNAH

Why are you helping me.

DR. REED

Because I lost someone once who didn't ask for help in time. That's the only reason.

She closes her fingers around the box.

HANNAH

Thank you.

She slips it into her scrub pocket. Walks out.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — EVENING

Hannah comes home. Roman at the counter. Wine. He looks up.

ROMAN

You ate?

HANNAH

A salad.

ROMAN

You're pale.

HANNAH

Long shift.

She crosses to the staircase. Stops.

HANNAH

Roman. Mira said something else. About my father.

Roman, very still.

ROMAN

What did she say.

HANNAH

Nothing yet. But she's going to.

She walks up the stairs.

3. INT. HANNAH'S BEDROOM — LATER

Hannah on the bed. Phone in hand. Calls Mom.

HANNAH

(quiet) Mom. Dad's accident. The night he died. I want to talk about it.

A long pause on the other end.

MOM (V.O.)

Baby. Why are you asking.

HANNAH

Because somebody just said it wasn't an accident.

Silence.

MOM (V.O.)

Come see me Sunday. We'll talk in person.

HANNAH

Mom —

MOM (V.O.)

Sunday, baby.

Hannah lowers the phone. Stares at the ceiling. Behind Hannah's closed bedroom door, Roman checks his phone. He sends Garrison a one-word message. 'Now'

EPISODE 27

1. INT. GARRISON'S OFFICE - NIGHT

A wood-paneled law office. GARRISON (60s, silver hair, expensive suit) at his desk. Roman across from him.

GARRISON

Mira Vance has been calling me for two weeks.

ROMAN

And?

GARRISON

Mira's getting close.

ROMAN

How close?

GARRISON

She knows about the shooting five years ago.

A beat.

GARRISON

And she's digging into your wife's father's death.

Roman goes still.

ROMAN

Bury it.

GARRISON

Already working on it.

ROMAN

And Mira?

GARRISON

One push and she's finished.

ROMAN

Do it.

Garrison nods.

GARRISON

One more thing.

Roman looks up.

GARRISON

Your wife is asking questions too.

Roman's jaw tightens.

ROMAN

She hears it from me.

GARRISON

Yes, Mr. Norton.

2. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — STAFF BATHROOM — SAME

Hannah at a sink on the fourth floor. The clinic-grade test from Reed on the counter beside her. Unopened. She picks it up. Phone buzzes.

ROMAN (V.O)

Coming home tonight?

She looks at the test. Puts the test back in her pocket. Unopened. Walks out.

The fourth-floor hallway. She gets two steps before — The world tilts.

Her hand hits the wall. She slides down it. Sitting on the cold tile.

A passing nurse turns.

NURSE

Dr. Carter — somebody help —

Hannah's vision narrows. Black at the edges.

EPISODE 28

1. INT. CITY HOSPITAL — TRAUMA BAY — NIGHT

Hannah on a gurney. Conscious but groggy. IV being placed. Reed at her side, fast, gloves on.

DR. REED

Hannah. Stay with me. Eyes open.

HANNAH

I'm okay.

DR. REED

You collapsed in a hallway. You're not okay.

Reed pulls a small ultrasound wand from the cart. Looks at Hannah.

DR. REED

(quiet) Do I have your permission.

Hannah, little eyes wet, nods. He lifts her scrub top just below the ribs. Cold gel. The wand moves. An image on the small screen. Reed studies it. His face softens.

DR. REED

(very quiet) Hannah. Look.

He turns the screen toward her. A tiny shape. A flutter. A heartbeat on the screen.

Hannah's hand flies to her mouth.

The trauma bay curtain rips open.

ROMAN. Suit. Coat. Marco behind. He saw the ER from the lobby, ran.

He stops mid-stride. Sees Hannah on the gurney. Reed with the wand. The screen.

The flutter. Roman, very still.

ROMAN

(quiet) What is that.

Reed straightens. Wipes the wand. Looks Roman in the eye.

DR. REED

Mr. Norton. Your wife is 7 weeks pregnant.

A long silence. Roman's eyes move from Reed. To the screen. To Hannah.

ROMAN

(very quiet, to Hannah) You knew.

Hannah, tears streaming, shakes her head.

HANNAH

I suspected. I didn't know.

ROMAN

(to Reed) You knew.

Reed doesn't lie.

DR. REED

I suspected since Monday. She told me
yesterday.

Roman's jaw locks.

He crosses the trauma bay. Slow. Stops at the side of the gurney
opposite Reed.

He looks down at Hannah. The wet face. The flutter still on the
paused screen.

He bends. Kisses her forehead. Soft.

Then turns his head. Looks at Reed.

ROMAN

Out.

Reed sets the wand on the cart.

DR. REED

Mr. Norton. She needs fluids and rest. I'm her
physician.

ROMAN

You were her physician.

ROMAN

Marco. Find her a new attending. Tonight.

Marco nods. Steps to the doorway.

Reed looks at Hannah. She closes her eyes.

Reed walks out.

Roman lifts her hand and brushes a kiss across her knuckles.

EPISODE 29

1. INT. PRIVATE HOSPITAL ROOM — NIGHT

A small private room. Norton-controlled facility. Hannah in a gown. IV in her arm.

Roman in the chair beside the bed. Suit jacket draped over the back. Sleeves rolled. He hasn't moved in two hours.

Hannah's eyes open slowly.

HANNAH

You're still here.

ROMAN

Yes.

HANNAH

Yell at me.

ROMAN

No.

I'm not going to yell at you.

She watches his face. She doesn't know what to do with this version of him.

HANNAH

I didn't tell you because I didn't tell myself first.

ROMAN

I know.

HANNAH

That's worse, isn't it.

ROMAN

It's just true.

He stands. Crosses to the bed. Sits on the edge of it. Cups her face. Thumb against her cheekbone.

ROMAN

You're carrying my child.

HANNAH

Yes.

ROMAN

And you didn't know how to tell me. Because I cut a man in a warehouse three nights ago.

Hannah's eyes fill.

HANNAH

Because I didn't know if our child should be born to a man who does that.

Roman, very still.

ROMAN

Fair.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

I said fair, Hannah. I'm not going to fight you on it.

He kisses her forehead. Lingers there.

ROMAN

You're keeping the baby?

HANNAH

I'm keeping the baby.

ROMAN

Then everything else, we figure out. Together.

HANNAH

Together.

He kisses her forehead again. Stands. Walks to the door.

ROMAN

Marco's outside. Sleep.

He leaves. Hannah, alone, gently places a hand over her stomach,

EPISODE 30

1. INT. MIRA'S PENTHOUSE - MORNING

Mira shuffles into the kitchen. Silk robe. Hair messy. Last night's makeup. She doesn't know yet. She pours coffee. Takes one sip. Sighs. A noise from the hallway outside. Muffled voices. Shuffling. She frowns. Sets down the mug. Walks to the door.

She pulls it open.

A WALL OF REPORTERS. Cameras. Microphones. Six. Eight. They surge forward.

REPORTER 1

Miss Vance - can you comment on your father's offshore accounts -

REPORTER 2

- federal investigation -

REPORTER 3

- Vance Holdings shell companies in the Caymans
-

Flashes. Microphones in her face. She stumbles backward.

MIRA

W-what - what are you -

She slams the door. Bolts it. Both locks. Back against the wood.

She walks shakily to the couch. Hannah picks up the remote and switches on the TV.

Breaking news fills the screen.

The headline: VANCE FAMILY HIDDEN ACCOUNTS - \$14M ROUTED THROUGH SHELLS.

Coffee mug slips from her hand. Hot coffee across the silk robe. Across the marble. She doesn't notice.

Footsteps on the stairs.

JULIAN comes down. Pajamas. Stitched lip. Black eye fading. He sees her on the couch. The wet robe. The tablet. The reporters' shadows under the door.

He doesn't ask. Walks past her to the kitchen. Pours himself coffee. Drinks it standing.

MIRA

Julian.

He doesn't answer.

MIRA

Julian. They're at the door. They're going to be at the door all day.

JULIAN

I heard them.

MIRA

We need to —

JULIAN

We?

He turns. Looks at her on the couch.

JULIAN

You did this. You go fix it.

MIRA

I'm your fiancée —

JULIAN

We're not married, Mira. We're not even close.
The ring on your finger doesn't make us a we.

MIRA

Julian.

JULIAN

You burned my uncle. You've got reporters at
your door. You're not my problem.

He sets the coffee down. Walks back to the stairs.

MIRA

JULIAN.

He doesn't stop.

MIRA

JULIAN — DON'T YOU WALK AWAY FROM ME —

The bedroom door closes upstairs.

Mira, alone on the couch. Wet robe. Cold coffee. Front-page
humiliation.

She SCREAMS. Long. Raw. Not theatrical this time. The first real
sound she's made in the series.

EPISODE 31

1.INT. NORTON MANSION — STUDY — EVENING

Roman at his desk. Reading something on his phone. He looks up as Hannah walks in.

She's been crying.

HANNAH

Did you know my father.

Roman, very still.

His phone, on the desk, vibrates. He doesn't look at it.

ROMAN

Hannah —

HANNAH

Did. You. Know him.

ROMAN

Yes.

Hannah sits down slowly in the chair across from his desk.

HANNAH

For how long.

ROMAN

He worked for Norton Industries for eleven years. I knew him as long as I knew the company.

HANNAH

Did he die in an accident.

ROMAN

No.

Hannah closes her eyes. Tears slip out anyway.

HANNAH

Tell me.

ROMAN

Not tonight.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

I will tell you everything. With your permission. On a day when you have not just been told this by your mother. When you have eaten. When you have slept.

HANNAH

You don't get to decide when I'm ready.

ROMAN

I'm not deciding. I'm asking.

He stands. Walks around the desk. Kneels in front of her chair. Takes both her hands.

ROMAN

One week. Give me one week. I'll tell you everything. Every part. I promise.

Hannah, after a long moment, nods once.

HANNAH

One week, Roman. If you push it by an hour, I leave with my mother.

ROMAN

Understood.

He lifts her hands to his lips. Kisses both of them.

He stands. Pulls her to her feet. Walks her to the study door.

ROMAN

Eat something. Please.

She nods. Walks out.

Roman, alone, picks up his phone. Reads the text he just got.

ON SCREEN – from Garrison: Mira filed a request for sealed records release. Federal court. Filing closes Friday.

EPISODE 32

1.INT. JULIAN'S OFFICE - DAY

A smaller office than the one in Episode 4. Julian's startup has been hit hard since the Vance scandal broke. Three desks empty. Receptionist gone. Julian alone at his desk. Bills open. Coffee cold. Bookie kicks the door open and storms in.

JULIAN

Hey, man - I told you I need another week -

BOOKIE

You don't have another week, Julian.

The interest doubled Friday. The principal doubled today.

JULIAN

I have collateral coming. Just give me until -

BOOKIE

Your rich fiancée's gone.

One more day. That's it.

Julian, white. Sweat at his hairline. He stares at the phone in his hand. The walls of the office. Scrolls his contacts. Stops on a name he hasn't dialed in two years.

ON SCREEN - RICCI.

He looks at the name for a long moment. The name of the family his uncle calls enemy.

He hesitates. His thumb hovers.

He presses call.

JULIAN

(into phone) Mr. Ricci. It's Julian Norton.

A pause on the other end.

JULIAN

Yes. That nephew. The one Roman cut out.

Another pause.

JULIAN

I have information your family will pay for.

He listens. Closes his eyes.

JULIAN

About my uncle. About his new wife.

A sinister smile spreads across his face.

EPISODE 33

1. INT. CAR — NIGHT

Roman at the wheel. Hannah beside him. Quiet road. City lights blurring across her face.

His right hand finds hers in her lap. Slow.

She doesn't pull away.

HANNAH

The thing in the warehouse. The man on his knees.

ROMAN

I know.

HANNAH

That was you doing your job?

ROMAN

That was me doing what the world I was raised in trained me to do.

HANNAH

And our baby. What world will our baby be trained in.

A long beat. Roman's thumb traces slow circles on her wrist.

ROMAN

Whatever world you decide. I'm in if you want me in. I'm out if you want me out.

HANNAH

That's the first thing you've said this week I believe.

ROMAN

Then keep believing it. Doctor.

The slow smile. Hannah's cheeks turn pink. She looks out the window.

HANNAH (V.O.)

Three nights. I told him three nights apart. So why am I already counting the hours?

He pulls up outside Mom's apartment building. Stops. Doesn't get out. Doesn't unlock the door.

ROMAN

Three nights.

HANNAH

Three nights.

She turns to open the door. His hand catches her chin. Tips her face toward him.

ROMAN

One thing first.

He kisses her. Slow. Lingering. Her hand fists in his shirt without thinking.

When he pulls back her breath is uneven.

ROMAN

Now you can go.

HANNAH

(barely)

You play dirty, Roman.

ROMAN

I play to win, little Doc.

She gets out. He watches her until she's safe in the lobby.

Through the building window — Hannah pauses on the staircase. Touches her lips with two fingers. Doesn't move for a long beat.

Then climbs the stairs.

EPISODE 34

1. INT. RICCI WAREHOUSE — DAY

A large, cold space on the docks. Industrial. Two men in jackets. Older. Hard.

JULIAN walks in. Marco's shadow not on him today — he slipped out the back of his building. The older man, RICCI PATRIARCH (70s), looks up from a desk.

RICCI PATRIARCH

Norton's nephew.

JULIAN

Just Julian. Not Norton anymore.

RICCI PATRIARCH

What do you have.

JULIAN

She's eight weeks pregnant.

RICCI PATRIARCH

The doctor wife.

JULIAN

His child. The next Norton heir.

The patriarch leans back. Looks at his lieutenant. The lieutenant nods.

RICCI PATRIARCH

What do you want.

JULIAN

Three hundred thousand.

RICCI PATRIARCH

For a name.

JULIAN

For everything. Her shift schedule. Her hospital. Her mother's address. Her movements.

The patriarch studies him.

RICCI PATRIARCH

And you sleep at night.

JULIAN

I sleep when I can pay my debts.

The patriarch nods to the lieutenant. The lieutenant slides a brick of cash across the desk.

JULIAN

Tomorrow I have her shift schedule. Friday I have her mother's daily walking route.

RICCI PATRIARCH

Friday. Don't be late.

Julian pockets the cash. Walks out.

Outside, on the sidewalk, he doesn't see Marco's second car parked across the street. Camera lens. Photo taken.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION — STUDY — LATER

The photo on Roman's desk. Julian. Brick of cash. Ricci's lieutenant in frame.

Roman looks at it for a long beat.

ROMAN

Marco.

MARCO

Boss.

ROMAN

He's not the nephew anymore. Treat him as Ricci. Watch what he does Friday.

MARCO

Yes, Boss.

ROMAN

Don't act on him yet. Let him show us how deep he's in.

MARCO

Understood.

Roman sets the photo face-down. Stares at it.

EPISODE 35

1.INT. MIRA'S PENTHOUSE — NIGHT

The penthouse half-empty. Furniture being removed by movers in the background. Tabloid covers still circling on a tablet.

Mira at her vanity. Makeup half-off. Robe. A KNOCK.

She freezes.

MIRA

(quiet) Reporters again?

VOICE (O.S.)

Open the door, Miss Vance.

She doesn't recognize the voice. Goes to the door. Looks through the peephole.

A man in a suit. Not Norton crew. Not Ricci crew. Federal.

She opens the door.

FED AGENT

Miss Vance. We've been authorized to offer you a deal. Limited window. Twenty-four hours.

MIRA

A deal for what.

FED AGENT

Cooperation. Against the Norton organization. In exchange for immunity on your father's offshore charges.

A long beat.

Mira's eyes light up. Then narrow.

MIRA

What do you need.

FED AGENT

What you know. About Roman Norton. About the night five years ago. About John Carter's death. Everything you've been pulling from public records.

Mira, slowly.

MIRA

I'll cooperate. But I want one thing in writing first.

FED AGENT

What.

MIRA

The wife. Hannah. She doesn't get charged with anything. Not now, not ever.

FED AGENT

Why.

MIRA

Because I want her watching while everything I tell you ruins her husband.

The agent nods slowly.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION - STUDY - SAME

Roman at his desk. Garrison on speakerphone.

GARRISON (V.O.)

She's making a federal deal. Tonight. I have it confirmed from three sources.

ROMAN

Time.

GARRISON (V.O.)

Twenty-four hours. Then she gives them everything she's compiled.

Roman, very still.

ROMAN

Hannah comes home tomorrow morning. Day six of seven.

GARRISON (V.O.)

Mr. Norton.

ROMAN

I'm telling her tonight. All of it. Before Mira can do it for me.

GARRISON (V.O.)

Tonight?

ROMAN

Tonight.

He hangs up. Picks up another phone. Different number.

ROMAN

Marco. Pick up my wife from her mother's at 8 PM. Bring her home.

EPISODE 36

1.INT. NORTON MANSION — WAR ROOM — NIGHT

A basement room Hannah has never seen. Long table. Maps. Screens. Six lieutenants standing. Roman at the head, sleeves rolled, suit jacket gone.

Hannah at the door, still in her dinner clothes. Phone in hand. The photo Julian sold to Ricci open on her screen — Marco intercepted it an hour ago.

ROMAN

You shouldn't be down here.

HANNAH

This is my mother.

She crosses. Sets the phone in front of him.

The photo: Mom, blindfolded, tied to a chair. Concrete floor.

The caption beneath: Forty-eight hours. The doctor and the heir, or the old woman dies.

Roman reads it. Doesn't react outwardly. Shows it to Marco.

MARCO

Background's gypsum board. Industrial light fixture. East side warehouse district.

ROMAN

How many warehouses.

MARCO

We own four. Ricci has six.

ROMAN

The one closest to the docks. Marcus took Julian there when he was a kid.

HANNAH

You know exactly which one.

ROMAN

I know exactly which one.

He stands. Buttons his cuffs.

HANNAH

'm coming too.

ROMAN

No.

HANNAH

My mother is there.

ROMAN

And that's exactly why you're staying here.

HANNAH

Roman—

He takes her face in his hands.

ROMAN

Listen to me.

ROMAN

I'm bringing your mother home.

ROMAN

For our family.

HANNAH's eyes well.

ROMAN

Two hours.

HANNAH

Roman—

ROMAN

(softly) Two hours.

ROMAN

When I come back, you, your mother, and I will
all be safe.

He kisses her forehead. Walks past her to the elevator.

Hannah, alone with three Norton lieutenants and a wall of screens.

The screens light up. Six SUVs leaving the mansion grounds at speed.

She watches her husband go to war.

EPISODE 37

1.EXT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE — DOCKS — NIGHT

A converted shipping facility. Roman's six SUVs roll up dark, no headlights. Crew piles out. Suppressed weapons.

Roman, vest under his shirt, gestures two fingers. The crew splits into three teams.

A Ricci sentry by the door. A Norton crewman takes him from behind. Quiet. Drops him.

2. INT. WAREHOUSE — MAIN FLOOR — CONTINUOUS

Industrial. Dim. A figure in the middle — MOM, tied to a chair, blindfolded. Two Ricci guards. More somewhere in the dark.

Gunfire. Brutal. Fast. Roman's crew clears the floor in thirty seconds.

Roman crosses to Mom. Cuts the blindfold first. Then the rope.

Mom blinks at him, terrified.

ROMAN

Mrs. Carter. I'm Roman. Hannah's husband. I'm taking you home.

Mom's hand drifts to his face. Her fingers touch his cheek. Her eyes search his.

A flicker of something. Recognition.

She doesn't say it. He's too focused on extraction to notice.

ROMAN

We have to move.

He lifts her in his arms.

3. EXT. WAREHOUSE — CONTINUOUS

They burst out the side door. Ricci reinforcements arrive at the far end of the lot — gunfire opens up. Roman, carrying Mom, has his back to the shooters.

A round catches him across the ribs. He grunts. Doesn't drop her.

His crew lays cover. They reach the SUV. Roman puts Mom inside. Marco slams the door.

ROMAN

GO.

The convoy peels out. Roman in the back seat with Mom. Bleeding through his shirt.

4.INT. NORTON MANSION — BATHROOM — LATER

Hannah finds Roman in his master bathroom. Shirt off. Trying to clean the wound himself.

She walks in without speaking. Takes the gauze from his hand. Pushes him to sit on the edge of the tub. Kneels.

The same body position as five years ago. As Episode 2.

She works.

HANNAH

Thank you for saving my mom

ROMAN

Third time you've stitched me, Doctor.

HANNAH

Don't talk.

She tapes the dressing. Her hand rests on his thigh just above the bandage.

HANNAH

I almost lost you tonight.

ROMAN

You didn't.

She looks up. Eyes wet.

EPISODE 38

1.INT. NORTON MANSION — GUEST ROOM — DAY

Mom in a borrowed sweater. Hannah on the bed next to her. Two cups of tea on the side table.

MOM

I'm fine, baby.

HANNAH

You were tied to a chair for fourteen hours.

MOM

I'm fine.

A beat. Mom takes Hannah's hand.

MOM

Tell me his name again.

HANNAH

Roman.

MOM

Roman, yes. Last night he carried me out of that warehouse.

HANNAH

I know.

MOM

He had a scar on his rib. Right side. Five years old.

Hannah, slowly.

HANNAH

Mom.

MOM

I saw a man at your father's hospital five years ago. Through the ICU window. The night your father — disappeared.

HANNAH

Mom, what are you saying.

MOM

The man with the scar in your husband's bathroom. Is the same man I saw bleeding in the ICU the night your father died.

A long silence.

HANNAH

You knew.

MOM

I never told you. For five years.

Because I never knew what he was to your father. Last night I found out.

HANNAH

You knew. While I was deciding whether to leave him.

MOM

I knew he was the man your father trusted.

Hannah, processing. Then she stands. Wipes her eyes. Bends. Kisses her mother's forehead.

HANNAH

Sleep.

She walks out.

2.INT. HALLWAY — A MOMENT LATER

Hannah leans her back against the wall outside the guest room. Closes her eyes. Lets out a long breath.

Down the hall — Roman walks out of his study. Sees her against the wall. He doesn't say anything. Crosses to her. Puts an arm around her. Walks her toward his bedroom.

EPISODE 39

1.INT. COMMISSION MEETING ROOM — NIGHT

A private dining room. Five older men around a circular table. Whiskey. No phones. Roman at one seat. The patriarch — a man in his seventies — at another.

Julian walks in. Two of Roman's crew on either side of him. Bruised. Suit dirty. He was picked up at the docks trying to flee.

JULIAN

This is illegal.

I have rights.

PATRIARCH

You sit at this table when invited.

You speak when invited. Tonight you do neither.

ROMAN

The evidence.

Marco drops a folder at Julian's feet. Photos. Bank transfers. Call records.

JULIAN'S face drains of color.

ROMAN

You sold your own family, not only my mother-in-law.

JULIAN

Roman, listen—

ROMAN

For three hundred thousand dollars.

JULIAN

I needed the money—

Roman rises. Silence fills the room.

ROMAN

You betrayed this family.

ROMAN

You endangered my wife.

JULIAN

Please—

ROMAN

Wrong answer.

Roman nods once.

Two men grab Julian.

PATRIARCH

You are stripped of the Norton name.

From this moment on, you're no one.

JULIAN freezes.

ROMAN

No money.

No protection.

No family.

ROMAN

And if I ever see you near Hannah again—

Roman leans down.

ROMAN

I'll finish what I started.

Julian goes pale.

ROMAN

Take him.

The men drag Julian away.

His screams echo down the hallway.

Roman never looks back.

JULIAN

Uncle. Please.

The crew lifts Julian. He doesn't resist this time. The door closes behind him.

EPISODE 40

1.EXT. FEDERAL COURTHOUSE — DAY

Cameras. Microphones. Roman in a dark suit, Garrison beside him.

REPORTER

Mr. Norton — is it true Norton is under federal
—

GARRISON

No comment.

They push through.

2. INT. HEARING ROOM — A LITTLE LATER

A panel of three federal investigators. Roman seated.

INVESTIGATOR

We've received testimony alleging financial fraud, money laundering, and conspiracy to murder John Carter five years ago. Respond?

ROMAN

Yes. Norton Industries did conduct illegal activity for decades. The man responsible — my brother Marcus — died five years ago. The day after John Carter died.

INVESTIGATOR

Your role.

ROMAN

I tried to save John Carter. I took three rounds doing so. Marcus shot him in front of me. My crew handled Marcus before I woke. I did not give that order, but I did not undo it.

Insert Flashback montage

INVESTIGATOR

You're admitting to homicide.

ROMAN

I'm admitting to inheriting one.

INVESTIGATOR

Why now.

ROMAN

My wife is pregnant. My child will be born to a name. I want that name to mean something different.

INVESTIGATOR

This panel reconvenes in seventy-two hours.

EPISODE 41

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — LIVING ROOM — EVENING

Hannah watching the news. Roman walks in. She stands. Crosses to him.

HANNAH

You confessed.

ROMAN

I told the truth.

HANNAH

They could lock you up for life.

ROMAN

They might.

She presses both hands flat on his chest.

HANNAH

Then we have seventy-two hours. I don't want to spend any of them apart.

Roman lifts her chin. Kisses her. Not soft this time. The kiss of a man who might not have another one.

He lifts her. Carries her toward the staircase.

2. INT. MASTER BEDROOM — NIGHT

Soft lamp. Door closed. Roman lowers Hannah onto the bed.

ROMAN

Tell me to stop.

HANNAH

Don't ever stop.

His shirt off. Her dress unzipped. His hand against her belly there's no visible sign of pregnancy yet.

ROMAN

The baby —

HANNAH

Stable now.

Besides, I'm a doctor.

His mouth on her neck. Her collarbone. Her —

Sensual flashes. Skin. Breath. His hand on her hip. Her fingers in his hair.

She gasps. He breathes her name into her shoulder.

3. INT. MASTER BEDROOM — LATER

They lie together under the sheet. His hand spread on her belly. She traces the rib scar with one finger.

HANNAH

If they take you Friday.

ROMAN

Don't.

HANNAH

Promise me you remember tonight.

ROMAN

Every second. Always.

EPISODE 42

1. INT. NORTON HOLDINGS — PRESS ROOM — DAY

A wood-paneled press room. Forty cameras. Roman at a podium in a black suit. Hannah beside him in a simple dress.

ROMAN

Julian Norton is no longer a Norton.

He betrayed my family.

He endangered my wife.

Roman reaches over and laces his fingers through Hannah's.

Camera flashes explode.

REPORTER

Are you admitting criminal activity inside Norton Holdings?

ROMAN

No.

ROMAN

The company is clean.

ROMAN

Anyone responsible will answer for it.

Roman steps away from the podium.

2. INT. MIRA'S APARTMENT — SAME

Mira on a couch. Wearing yesterday's clothes. Empty wine bottle. She watches the press conference on a small TV.

She sees Hannah on screen. Standing beside Roman.

Mira's jaw locks.

She picks up her phone. Calls the federal agent.

MIRA

(into phone)

I have more.

FED AGENT (V.O.)

Miss Vance.

MIRA

A specific incident. A man in a warehouse.
Roman cut the cheek of a woman in a hospital
ER. I have witnesses.

FED AGENT (V.O.)

We already heard about the ER. Press it as a
defense matter.

MIRA

The other one. The warehouse. He held a dagger
to a hospital director's hand.

FED AGENT (V.O.)

Witnesses?

MIRA

Hannah Carter saw it. Roman's own wife saw him
do it.

A pause.

FED AGENT (V.O.)

You'd subpoena his wife.

MIRA

I'd subpoena his wife. Yes.

EPISODE 43

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — MORNING

Hannah at the marble island. Pregnant belly under a soft sweater. Coffee — decaf now. Roman across from her, reading the morning headlines on a tablet.

A knock at the front door. Marco's voice.

MARCO (O.S.)

Boss. Subpoena server at the gate.

Roman doesn't look up.

ROMAN

Let him through.

A federal marshal walks in. Sets a folded document on the island.

MARSHAL

Dr. Hannah Carter. You are summoned to appear before the federal panel on Thursday at 10 AM. Subject: the conduct of Roman Norton in your presence.

Hannah picks up the document. Reads.

She doesn't react.

MARSHAL

Thank you for your time.

He leaves.

HANNAH

She did it.

ROMAN

She did.

HANNAH

She's going to ask me whether you cut Mira's father's hand.

ROMAN

She's going to ask you whether you saw violence in my house.

HANNAH

The answer is yes to both.

A beat.

ROMAN

You testify honestly.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

You testify honestly, Hannah. I will not have my child's mother lie under oath. Not for me. Not ever.

She looks at him for a long moment.

HANNAH

If I tell the truth, you go to prison.

ROMAN

If you lie, you go to prison. The choice is whose life it is.

She closes her eyes.

HANNAH

I want to bring my own counsel.

ROMAN

Garrison will arrange whoever you want.

HANNAH

Not Garrison. Someone clean. Someone not on Norton retainer.

ROMAN

Done.

She stands. Walks around the island. Stops behind his chair. Puts both arms around his shoulders. Presses her cheek to the top of his head.

HANNAH

I'm not going to lie. I'm just going to tell them everything.

EPISODE 44

1.INT. FEDERAL HEARING ROOM — DAY

Same panel. Hannah at the witness chair. Her own counsel beside her. Roman in the gallery. Mira in the back row, dressed for court, eyes locked on Hannah.

The investigator slides a folder forward.

INVESTIGATOR

Dr. Carter. On the night of October fourteenth, did you witness your husband threaten Mr. Vance with a dagger?

HANNAH

Yes.

INVESTIGATOR

Did he cut Mr. Vance?

HANNAH

No.

INVESTIGATOR

But he threatened to.

HANNAH

Yes.

INVESTIGATOR

Why didn't you call the police.

HANNAH

Three days before that, his daughter attacked me with a scalpel.

A beat.

HANNAH

My husband gave her a warning.

HANNAH

Not a wound.

INVESTIGATOR

You're defending him.

HANNAH

No.

HANNAH

I'm telling the truth.

The investigator leans forward.

INVESTIGATOR

Is your husband a violent man?

HANNAH

No.

A beat.

HANNAH

He's a man trying to leave violence behind.

HANNAH

He stood before this panel because he wants our child to inherit a clean name.

Silence.

INVESTIGATOR

Thank you, Dr. Carter.

2. INT. COURTHOUSE STEPS – LATER

Reporters surge. Hannah walks down with her counsel. Roman behind her.

REPORTER

Dr. Carter – do you stand by your husband?

Hannah stops. Turns. Looks straight into the camera.

HANNAH

I stand by my husband.

Roman, behind her, lets out a breath.

Across the steps – Mira walks away alone. Her counsel jogging after her.

3. INT. NORTON MANSION – MASTER BEDROOM – NIGHT

Door closed. Roman against the door. Hannah's hands on his shoulders. She just pushed him there.

HANNAH

I chose you in front of the world today.

Now I want to be your wife.

Truly

Roman lifts her. Carries her to the bed. Her dress over her head. His shirt on the floor.

His mouth on her shoulder. Her collarbone. Her –

Sensual flashes. Skin. Breath. Pregnancy belly between them, careful, slow.

She gasps his name. He kisses her mouth quiet.

EPISODE 45

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — MASTER BEDROOM — MORNING

Soft light. Hannah on her side, asleep. Roman behind her. He kisses her bare shoulder. She wakes.

HANNAH

Do you want to know the baby's gender?

ROMAN

Boy or girl, I don't care.

ROMAN

As long as I get to have them with you.

HANNAH

Come on. Pick one.

ROMAN

A daughter.

HANNAH

Why?

ROMAN

Because she'll look like you.

Hannah laughs.

HANNAH

Congratulations.

ROMAN

For what?

HANNAH

You're already a girl dad.

He bends. Kisses her belly. Lingers there. Then her mouth.

HANNAH

You're nervous about Thursday.

ROMAN

I'm not nervous.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

I'm prepared.

HANNAH

For prison.

ROMAN

For whatever they decide.

She lifts her hand. Touches his face. He closes his eyes.

HANNAH

If they take you for three years.

ROMAN

You don't wait. I told Garrison. He has the divorce papers drafted. Sign them the day I'm sentenced.

HANNAH

Roman.

ROMAN

Our daughter doesn't grow up with a father in a cage. She grows up with a mother who's free.

Hannah, tears.

HANNAH

I'd never sign them.

ROMAN

I know. That's why I told Garrison anyway.

His phone, on the nightstand, lights up. He doesn't look at it. It lights again. Then a third time.

HANNAH

Roman.

He reaches over. Reads. His face shifts.

HANNAH

What.

ROMAN

The federal panel reached a decision early.

HANNAH

And!

EPISODE 46

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — MASTER BEDROOM — CONTINUOUS

Hannah's eyes widen. Across from her, Roman is staring intently at his phone.

ROMAN

Probation. Three years. Restitution. The Norton name stays on the legal entity. Norton Industries dissolves Friday.

Hannah's eyes fill.

HANNAH

You're not going to prison.

ROMAN

I'm not going to prison.

She presses her face into his shoulder. Cries quietly. He wraps both arms around her. Holds her like she might disappear.

HANNAH

(into his shoulder)

I was so scared, Roman.

ROMAN

I know.

HANNAH

I haven't slept in three weeks.

ROMAN

I know.

He bends. Kisses the top of her head. Then her temple. Then her mouth. Slow. Lingerin

HANNAH

What about Mira?

ROMAN

Garrison says the federal panel rejected her immunity request this morning. She's facing the full charges.

HANNAH

So it's done. Mira. Julian. The federal investigation. All of it.

ROMAN

Almost.

His phone vibrates again. He doesn't look at it.

It buzzes a second time.

HANNAH

Roman.

He reaches over. Reads. His face shifts. The relief is gone.

HANNAH

What.

ROMAN

There's one more text.

HANNAH

Read it.

ROMAN

Marco. Julian was spotted three blocks from
your hospital tonight. With two men.

Hannah lifts her head. Pulls back from his arms.

HANNAH

Two men?

ROMAN

Two men.

He picks up the phone. Types one line back. Hannah watches.

ROMAN

(to Marco, voice tightening)

Double the perimeter. Around the hospital.
Around the mansion. Around her mother.

Hannah's hand drifts to her belly. Without thinking.

HANNAH

He wouldn't.

ROMAN

He would.

A long beat. Outside, a car door slams in the driveway. Roman's eyes
flick to the window.

EPISODE 47

1.INT. CITY HOSPITAL — OB CLINIC — DAY

Hannah on the exam table. A small baby bump is beginning to show. One of Roman's suited men inside the exam room. Two more in the corridor.

Obstetrician doing the ultrasound. Image on the screen. A small healthy shape. Strong flutter heartbeat.

Obstetrician

Strong heartbeat. Position is head-down. Growth on track. We're good.

Hannah exhales. Smiles for the first time in days.

HANNAH

Thank you. Don't worry, baby.

Everything's going to be alright now.

The OB wipes the gel. Excuses herself.

The Norton guard inside the room glances at his phone. Steps just outside the door for a moment to take a text.

Hannah sits up. Reaches for her sweater.

A new face enters the room. Doctor's coat. Stethoscope. ID badge dangling.

DR. STRANGER

Mrs. Norton. I'm Dr. Davis. Just need a quick follow-up note.

HANNAH

I just finished —

He pulls the mask down.

Julian.

Hannah's mouth opens to scream. He's faster. Cloth over her mouth. Sweet smell. Chloroform.

She kicks. Hits the exam table. The tray crashes.

The Norton guard outside hears it. Pushes the door —

LOCKED. Julian threw the bolt.

NORTON GUARD

Mrs. Norton — open the door —

Julian, low to Hannah's ear.

JULIAN

Don't fight me, Aunt Hannah. Don't make it worse for the baby.

Her eyes flutter. Vision narrows.

Julian opens the side door — a connecting room. Drags her through. Out a service exit. Black van waiting.

2. INT. NORTON MANSION - STUDY - SAME

Roman at his desk. Phone rings. Marco. He picks up.

MARCO (V.O., RAW)

Boss. She's kidnapped. Julian took her out.

Roman stands. Coffee cup tips. Spills across the desk. He doesn't notice.

ROMAN

Find them.

EPISODE 48

1.INT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE — DAY

Hannah wakes on a folding chair. Wrists tied behind her. Chloroform haze fading.

Julian across the room. Pacing. A gun in his hand. No Ricci men this time — he's alone.

JULIAN

You're awake. Good.

HANNAH

Julian.

JULIAN

You know what your husband took from me? My name. My business. My fiancée's family. Even my fucking apartment.

HANNAH

You did all of that yourself.

JULIAN

NO.

He lunges. Stops two feet from her. The gun in her face.

JULIAN

You. You did it. The day you walked into his ER five years ago. The day you didn't die in your studio apartment. The day you opened your legs for him in a goddamn car.

HANNAH

Julian. Step back.

JULIAN

I'm going to erase you. And whatever's in your belly. I'm going to wipe out every trace of you from his life. Then he'll know what I felt.

He raises the gun toward her belly.

HANNAH

Don't —

A door SLAMS open.

ROMAN.

Julian whips around. Fires once. Wide. Roman drops behind a crate.

Gunfire. Quick. Two shots from Roman. Both into Julian's legs.

Julian SCREAMS. Hits the concrete. The gun skitters.

Roman crosses the warehouse in five strides. Kicks the gun away. Stands over Julian.

Julian, crawling backward. Bleeding from both thighs.

JULIAN

Uncle — Uncle, please —

Roman doesn't speak. Walks past him to Hannah. Drops to his knees.
Cuts her wrists free.

ROMAN

Are you hurt.

HANNAH

The baby — she's kicking. We're okay.

He pulls her against his chest. Holds her.

Behind him, sirens approach. Federal. Marco called them on the way.

Roman, into Hannah's hair.

ROMAN

I've got you.

EPISODE 49

1. INT. NORTON MANSION — KITCHEN — MORNING

Sunlight. Hannah at the marble island. Decaf coffee. Belly heavy. Calm.

Roman across from her. He hasn't taken his eyes off her since they came home.

The TV on the wall plays muted news.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O., MUTED)

...Julian Norton sentenced to thirty years for attempted murder, kidnapping, and conspiracy. Mira Vance pleaded guilty to fraud and accessory charges, sentenced to twelve years...

Roman picks up the remote. Turns it off.

HANNAH

It's done.

ROMAN

It's done.

A beat.

HANNAH

Twelve years for Mira. Thirty for Julian.

ROMAN

And no parole on his.

HANNAH

And Norton Industries?

ROMAN

Dissolved on Friday. Norton Holdings is a legal entity. Audited. Compliant.

She reaches across the marble. Takes his hand.

HANNAH

We're free.

ROMAN

We're free.

A small kick from inside. Hannah laughs. Pulls his hand to her belly.

HANNAH

She agrees.

2. INT. NURSERY — A LITTLE LATER

A finished nursery. Crib. Soft pastel walls. Mom rocking in the chair, folding tiny clothes.

Hannah in the doorway. Roman behind her.

MOM

You're sure about the name.

HANNAH

Joan. For Dad.

Mom's eyes fill.

MOM

He would have loved that. He would have loved her.

Hannah crosses. Puts both arms around Mom.

EXT. NORTON MANSION — TERRACE — EVENING

Roman and Hannah on a couch outside. Sunset. Her head on his shoulder.

ROMAN

Wedding?

HANNAH

After she's born.

ROMAN

You don't want it before.

HANNAH

I want her in my arms when you say I do.

Roman kisses the top of her head.

ROMAN

After she's born.

EPISODE 50

1.INT. CHURCH — DAY (THREE MONTHS LATER)

A modest stone church. White flowers. Family and crew filling the pews.

Marco at the altar beside Roman as best man. Roman in a black suit.

The doors at the back open.

Mom walks Hannah down the aisle. Joan, three months old, awake in Hannah's arms — held against her white dress.

Hannah, in a simple gown. Joan in pale lace.

She reaches the altar. Mom kisses her cheek. Steps back.

OFFICIANT

The bride and groom have prepared their own
vows.

Hannah turns to Roman. Joan between them.

HANNAH

I married a stranger to save my mother.

Roman's eyes flicker.

HANNAH

I'm marrying you to be your family for the rest
of my life.

ROMAN

I married you to keep you alive.

A beat.

ROMAN

I'm marrying you so I can finally start living.

OFFICIANT

You may kiss the bride.

They kiss. Joan between them, tiny hand pressed against Roman's chest. The church erupts.

EXT. CHURCH STEPS — A LITTLE LATER

Guests laughing outside. Mom on a bench in the sun.

Marco beside her.

MOM

(quiet, to Marco)

Will he keep her safe.

MARCO

With his life. He has for five years already.

Mom smiles. Watches Roman lift Joan high into the sunlight.

Hannah laughing beside him.